Israelis responded, with the consent of Prime Minister Rabin, that the peace negotiations with Jordan were the prime minister's top priority.

A short time later, the Oslo Accords became public.

Of course, Jordan as a state and Hussein personally favored the agreement and supported understandings with the Palestinians. However, one of the pillars of Jordan's strategy had always been to be involved in what was happening between Israel and the Palestinians, whether actively or passively, and this position had been acceptable to the Israelis. As mentioned, over the course of 1993, Hussein repeatedly told the Israelis that there was something going on between Israel and the Palestinians, and the Israeli negotiators, knowing nothing about it, denied it. This indicates that while there are advantages to clandestine contacts and secret negotiations, if the top ranks of the intelligence community are not all in on the secret, such situations may occur. The fact that the Israelis denied that something was indeed happening on the Palestinian track undermined Hussein's confidence in them. Another event that increased this mistrust occurred in October 1993, when Prime Minister Rabin met with the king in Aqaba. The meeting took place under a cloak of secrecy, at the king's request, but even so, the following morning the meeting was reported in the Israeli media. And I have already mentioned the statement that Shimon Peres, then deputy prime minister and minister of foreign affairs, leaked to journalists following his meeting with the king in Amman, during which far-reaching understandings were reached ahead of an agreement: "Remember November Second." As stated, this series of events led within a few months to the king lashing out at his Israeli interlocutors at one of the meetings, saying, "You have put out a contract on my life," a declaration that accurately reflected the anger and despair that he felt as a result of the leaks.

In conclusion, it is worth pointing out the relationship between the two leaders and their ability to look beyond the peace agreement and examine the potential for solving the problems of the entire Middle East. Once it was clear that there was to be an agreement, but before it had been drafted and signed, the two men discussed the potential role Iraq could play in solving all the problems of the Middle East. Iraq was a country that had it all: large areas of arable land, a relatively small population in comparison to its land area, and unlimited water and energy resources. Only such a country—in the post–Saddam Hussein era, obviously—could contribute to solving the issues of water, energy, refugees, and population surpluses in the Middle